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COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Senior Director of Product and Engineering Operations at Smartly.io Believes Intercom's Fin AI Enhances Workflow Efficiency but Highlights Areas for Improvement

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
24 Jun 2026	26 Mar 2026	Customer	Business-Led	FIN

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The interview covered the expert's experience evaluating, selecting, and implementing Intercom's Fin AI for customer support, focusing on buying factors such as automation, integration, proof of concept, and ease of use. The discussion also addressed the importance of pre-sales collaboration, pricing transparency, and the role of self-serve tools in the adoption process.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Senior Director of Product and Engineering Operations at a B2B SaaS company, with direct involvement in selecting, evaluating, and implementing customer support tools, including AI-powered solutions like Intercom's Fin AI, and experience in integrating these tools with internal systems and processes.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- **The expert is generally satisfied with the performance and integration of Intercom's Fin AI, particularly appreciating its automation and ease of use, but notes room for improvement in areas like customer sensitivity tagging and deeper agentic AI capabilities**.
- **The expert values strong proof of concept and pre-sales collaboration**, emphasizing the importance of maintaining high customer satisfaction (CSAT) and ROI, but expresses a desire for greater transparency and engineering support from the vendor.
- Pricing transparency and predictability are important, but the expert is more focused on overall workflow efficiency and ROI than on achieving the lowest contract price.

TAKEAWAYS

- Intercom's Fin AI was adopted after **earlier versions failed to meet quality standards**; improvements in the tool and internal readiness led to successful implementation in November 2025.
- **Key buying factors included security and compliance (rated highly important), automation performance, and ease of use, with the expert rating Intercom highly but noting some limitations in advanced features and customer segmentation**.
- Proof of concept and pre-sales testing were critical to the decision, with the vendor providing strong support but lacking some transparency and deeper engineering involvement.
- Integration with existing systems (Salesforce, Jira, Document360) was mostly out-of-the-box and straightforward, with the expert's organization capable of handling additional customizations as needed.
- **Self-serve tools, documentation, and ease of setup were strong points for Intercom, enabling quick deployment and value realization, with the expert noting that most impact** was seen within the first two months of implementation.

AlphaSense Assistant is AI Generated

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Expert Bio

Senior Director of Product and Engineering Operations at Smartly.io (customer of Intercom). The expert is responsible for leading Smartly.io's product development operations. Senior Director of Product and Engineering Operations at Smartly.io. The expert is responsible for leading Smartly.io's product development operations. Developing and executing strategic plans aligned with Smartly

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objectives. Implementing efficient methodologies to enhance product development lifecycle. Establishing Product Operations in Smartly and orchestrating seamless coordination across product teams for optimal results. Oversees resource allocation and budgeting to maximize efficiency. 20+ years of experience in product development operations.

Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

I can give you a little bit of the context on what we're doing. We are currently researching some of the main players in the AI agents market. That includes Sierra, Decagon, Intercom, Forethought, etc. Before we start with some questions on the buying factors, can you tell us a little bit more about your experience with Intercom, the role that you played in the decision-making process, and your experience working with Intercom overall?

Expert 00:00:25

I'm a product operations manager for a company. We use Intercom as our way to support our customer. This is a tool that power our customer support organization. It's not directly my organization, but I'm very involved on how we support them from a product perspective. Therefore, working with the head of support to select the best tool, tune the best tool.

Intercom has been with us for a little bit more than four years. It was already a set of tools before AI came. We have, since November of 2025, enabled the AI agent called Fin AI, which is powered by one of the big work that my team is doing, which is knowledge base. That's basically my involvement with that, helping to select the tool, evaluating the response of the tool, and then feeding them with great information.

Client 00:01:13

That's good to know. I'm interested in the Fin part. You mentioned you enabled in November last year. I want to understand first how did that happen? Was there a need from your organization to improve or automate your customer service operations and then you reached out to Intercom, or did they reach out to you? Tell me how it started, the idea or the need to implement Fin.

Expert 00:01:39

The need has always been there. We've always been looking for maximizing the customer experience while reducing the cost of their support with Fin AI. We have about 30 people working in the support team across the globe. We have an increasing amount of customers and an ever increasing amount of features, and I think it's more the last one that is hard to cope with. The scoped of the product is really getting extremely big.

I work for a company called Smartly. It's a B2B SaaS orchestrating social and programmatic campaign. We went from three channels to 15 channels in three years and also increasing the number of feature we support. **That's extremely hard** for the CS team to follow, to support, to get trained on this feature. Having Fin AI in the middle helped them to cope with a lot of learning. They still need to learn. That's the combined effect of the growth of the company and the need to scale but not at the same rate as the company. We could put that as team efficiency. That brought the push of enabling AI. Overall, there is a big push in the company to use AI as much as possible.

Client 00:02:52

Understood. Why did this happen in November 2025? Fin AI was launched way, way earlier. What was the catalyst?

Expert 00:03:04

We tried the earlier version, and **they were not satisfactory**. We are pretty proud of our CSAT. I think we have a 98% CSAT from our customer, and we want to keep that. Selling value, Smartly is a bit above the market, but we preach for our support and our quality. That's part of the things we want to keep. That's why we wait for Fin AI to really become better in terms of output of the support of the customer to start rolling it up. We did some few trials when they were not even the first month. They were fixing it because it was too new. In November, after doing a few rounds, few months of test, they said, "Go ahead and go for production."

Client 00:03:46

That's good to know. Final question on this. In this process, in November 2025, did you also consider other vendors or were you just evaluating Fin?

Expert 00:03:58

We were just evaluating Fin AI at the moment because we had already this whole integration within Intercom. We were not ready to use other tool inside the support chat. Since then, we have developed a bit more internal tooling, a bit more other AI tooling. We do have say the

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same service of Fin AI proposed internally for our employees through Slack bots, and **it's also quite satisfactory**. There is a moment where we're going to have a look and say like, "Can we bring our own bot? They are trained on the same source anyway. Everything comes from the knowledge base. Use that as a way to communicate directly with the customer."

Unless Fin AI start to really, really perform even better than what it is today, and then will keep it. The problem is Intercom is here to stay. We don't really necessarily want to change the tool that is doing the customer support interface for the moment. I think we have a contract for another three years with Intercom for the basic support and chat, and Fin AI is a contract on top.

Client 00:05:01

You mentioned that you have tried earlier and it didn't work and now it did work in 2025. Do you think that the reason why it didn't work a few years ago when you initially tried it was because of the capabilities that Fin AI was missing, **the tool itself was not so good,** or was it more like, internally, you were not ready, your knowledge base was not set up properly? Can you tell me more about that? Was it from the vendor side or internal cases, the reason why you weren't ready?

Expert 00:05:31

I would say it's mainly from the vendor side, from the capability side. It took them a few times to get to better results, better management. **We can see, even since November, some improvement from their side on the algorithm**. I think that was part of the learning phase. I don't think we were also ready on our end, especially doing proper QA analysis. That also gave us time to adapt to that.

What happens not only in the customer support side, but also, overall, on the company, was to have what **we call that an AI tiger team**. Really, a team that is able to bring AI every way it's needed as a quick hack, tooling, or the proper solution, that also educated everyone around how that works, how to test it, how to evaluate the answer. That's what has changed also, I would say, from March, April to November. Mainly, it was due to the capability. If you had rock star answer in April, we would have adopted earlier.

Client 00:06:32

All right. Let's move on to the buying factors. As part of this, I want to go deeper into what you mentioned on how they worked with you to prove the concept. That is actually one of our buying factors. Let me start with the ones that are related to product. First, I want to get your perspective on how important the buying factor is in terms of the decision. Here, it's on a scale of 1-5. One is it's not important at all, it doesn't move the needle at all for you. Two, it's somewhat important. Three, important. Four, very important. Five, it's absolutely a critical buying factor. That's the first part.

The second part of the buying factors, I want to get your perspective on how Intercom performs on that buying factor. In there, **a rating of one would be very poor performance**. A poor performance, two. Average performance, three. A good performance, four. Excellent performance at five. For each buying factor, I'm looking to get two answers, the importance of the buying factor and your perception on the performance. Here, I'm talking specifically about Fin and its buying factor. Let's get started with the first one. The buying factor is the capabilities around security compliance and data privacy. How important was that in the decision on a scale of 1-5?

Expert 00:08:05

Relatively important. We are careful with that. We manage customers that are competitors to one another. We have specific clause in our contract, but that's always something that we are quite careful, managing competitors inside the same app. It's not that we have a multi-tenancy, so that's something that is relatively important.

Client 00:08:27

What would you rate the importance from 1-5?

Expert 00:08:31

If I rate the importance from 1-5, in the specific of Fin AI for Intercom, I would say a five.

Client 00:08:37

Five in terms of importance. In terms of the Intercom capabilities or performance in this buying factor, how would you rate Intercom?

Expert 00:08:46

I would rate them an overall four. I think they are doing good.

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Client 00:08:51

Is there a reason why it's four and not five? Did you notice anything that was missing that you would have liked to see from Fin AI to rate it a five?

Expert 00:09:01

Maybe just because I'm a hard ass and it's really hard to get a five from me. I would see a bit more simplicity, a bit more ability to tag customer by sensitivity differently, which is today a bit missing. We can do it on our side with customer segmentation, but it would be better handled in Intercom.

Client 00:09:19

Thank you. Second buying factor is the quality and the accuracy of the AI agent. In here, I'm talking specifically about Fin and the importance that you put in having an AI agent that gave responses that were real. In other words, no hallucinations, and also, responses that were relevant, that it was pulling the right content from your knowledge base to the customer. How important was that from 1-5?

Expert 00:09:39

I would say very important. Maybe not the five but four. I will explain my answer. The answer is also very contextual. We have different channels, not everything work in the same way. There is very complex edge case scenario that is not easy to grasp, and luckily, we have a very well-documented knowledge base and we took a lot of effort. That was effortless that started three years ago. I would say out of the box, **it performed already** quite well on common use case. On more complex edge cases, really is depending on how good is the knowledge base.

Most of the articles are good, some need updating. When it needs updating, we can see that the topic is usually then handled by a human. That's a good way for us to know also where the knowledge base needs some care. Strong foundation of Fin AI of the data and accuracy, which is relatively important because it's a lot of complexity to manage. I would say important, five, and then it would be hard to say, I would only put three on the happiness on Fin AI because I believe most of the work is coming from the knowledge base.

Client 00:10:52

That's interesting. Your AI agent within is only based on the knowledge base. In other words, it doesn't have any specific procedures or integrations to manage customer interactions that are not covered by the knowledge base.

Expert 00:11:07

No, just the knowledge base.

Client 00:11:09

All right. You would rate it a three because it's because **your KB is very good** that they're also able to perform. The next buying factor is the automation performance. In here, all of this is your perception when you were making the decision to buy Fin. This buying factor is specifically how important was it for you that the vendor was able to achieve high automation rates.

Expert 00:11:36

I would say then that drives directly the efficiency of the whole team. Roughly, today, Fin AI is involved in more than 80% of our chat conversations. It's doing 30%-40%, depending on the month resolution. Where it's failing is a bit on the customer satisfaction score. It's not where we rate the best. On the automation, it's good.

We are managing a high volume of conversation. It's around 15,000 a month. It's able to link the tickets, route them properly, link to the knowledge base, to the FAQ, so pretty good. **It's, again, limitation of more complex cross system automation** that we can have. We have different lines of support that sometimes the orchestration is not always perfect. Compared to the volume we manage, **we are relatively happy**. Automation is a four on the need to have strong automation, and then the satisfaction is a four as well.

Client 00:12:36

All right. Moving on to the next one. **It's the ease of use and time** to value. Having an AI agent that is easy to use to set up and that you can start seeing the value quickly, how important was that, scale of 1-5?

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Expert 00:12:54

That is the strong part of Intercom, overall. Even if there is some few adjustments and I could tell them some few improvement, overall, they're pretty good. It can be operated pretty quickly. You can see the impact pretty fast. Getting the agent, the automation was relatively easy. Again, for everything that is basic workflow, simple things, it works. When it's more complex and you need a bit more time, this is where **you're also going to find the limitation of Intercom**. No tool is perfect.

I would say t's going to be weird what **I'm going to say, because the ease of use** has changed also in the fact that now we have Fin AI. We used to have CSM participating in the support. They had 10 hours to book per month of supporting the customer and playing the role of a CS agent. Since we have Fin AI, we have stopped doing that. Where it was super important to have ease of use in middle of last year, because we had a lot of people doing the CS agent role but coming from different role, it's not extremely savvy.

Now, we only have a team of CS, where the daily job is really to spend time on Intercom. Ease of use is, I would say, four. The satisfaction is five. It's something that if we had to choose today, I will only maybe give it to three because I know I'm going to have a team of solid professional using it. I hope that makes sense what I'm saying.

Client 00:14:21

Got it. Can you tell me a little bit more about the time to value? You mentioned it was quick and you also mentioned earlier that you achieved 30%-40% resolutions. Once you sign the contract with Intercom, how quickly did you achieve these numbers?

Expert 00:14:40

Relatively quick. Honestly, we have been seeing this number maybe not from the first month, but from the second month. That has been there pretty quickly.

Client 00:14:51

How fast did you start seeing the impact? How fast did you have a working AI agent that was able to answer questions with your knowledge base, even if it didn't reach 40%? I wonder how quick was this deployed?

Expert 00:15:07

Deployed very quickly. Few clicks of a button and you have it running. Now we have it running. On our test environment in April, we evaluate the quality of the answer and said "No, not yet ready." We restart that somewhere in September, do a more deeper proof of concept with only few customer, and it worked. In November, switching to say that we'll go now to full production and happy to contract. It was just paperwork.

Client 00:15:36

Okay. A lot of these things that you're mentioning were pre-sales. You signed the contract on November. It seems like you did all of the testing and proof of concept before you signed the contract. By the time you signed the contract, the AI agent was already functional but it was only a matter of moving into production. Is that correct?

Expert 00:16:03

Exactly.

Client 00:16:04

Thank you. Moving on to the next buying factor, I want to also understand the product features. We already discussed the accuracy and the security and compliance resolution performance. In here, I'm talking more about other product features of Fin, like the ability to do testing, the ability to write instructions, procedures, all of that. How important was having these product features as part of your decision-making process?

Expert 00:16:36

I would say more focusing towards the integration. I think we covered already the automation, so I wouldn't put too much the automation in that. The other feature we use and we always been using even before AI, the chat, the email. The in-app notification is a thing that we use frequently. I didn't see any impact from Fin AI on that. Maybe I should double-check and review now that you asked the question. They are quite important. They're important especially for Intercom because that's what makes it sticky for us.

We are looking honestly at different tool in the future to have a better in-app support of our customer. Since maybe January 2025. We have removed the NPS survey out of Intercom and developed it in-house because it was simply too expensive with Intercom. In terms of feature,

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they have some good one. **The survey was not good enough for us**, we needed more ability to configure tune, and then they came back with a higher price, so we decided to develop it in-house.

Client 00:17:39

Okay. Are you talking about Fin features now or overall?

Expert 00:17:44

No. Overall features. What are the specific Fin features I can discuss on top of automation and security?

Client 00:17:52

The main ones will be testing and you mentioned integrations as well in product. Other in-product features are things like monitoring and reporting, things like that. I'm talking specifically about Fin. Was **that important in your buying decision to have other strong product features beyond automation security and accuracy,** or was that not really important?

Expert 00:18:15

No, that was then not that important because I'm not going to tell them, "Don't come in. I think we have a full test environment already." That's where we have Fin AI in there.

Client 00:18:28

Okay. On a scale of 1-5, what would you say?

Expert 00:18:32

Look, it's really good. I don't know how to answer specifically, but if we really just add security and the automation, then that's already noted.

Client 00:18:41

If there were no other product features that were important, perhaps it's not that important.

Expert 00:18:47

If we look at the integration with the knowledge base, I put that in the automation or we discussed it, and that was super important. The other things I would say that is in the automation. The escalation to human agent is also working super well. The escalation is relatively good, and that was critical, but for me, that's part of the automation. The way it's configured, also the setup of Fin AI is all button click and no-code approach. That's good as well.

Client 00:19:17

From the things that you're mentioning, I would say the integration is definitely part of automation. I put the other elements like the testing environment, the escalation to human agents, and the configuration as these other features that I'm referring to.

Expert 00:19:33

Maybe I can add more, which is the context, the customer data, which is good. It's already something we were interconnecting Intercom and Salesforce. Fin AI is able to pick up the customer context. We have customer tiering, the importance of different customer. It also is able to pick up that as well. That's a good feature as well.

Client 00:19:54

All right. On a scale of 1-5, what do they say is the importance of these other product features?

Expert 00:20:04

I would put three. Compared to the others, they are less important. On the satisfaction, I will put to four.

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Client 00:20:12

Sounds good. Anything that you would have liked to see from Intercom for that to be a five? Any feature that you thought was missing or did not work great?

Expert 00:20:23

When we see now more agentic AI coming with more cross system action, that would be good to start seeing that. If there is integration, that would be great that, we see that more coming from Intercom. That would be really a hard hat for them, but that would be great, a true agent behavior.

Client 00:20:41

Sounds good. Moving on to the next one then, I want to get into the selling approach from Intercom. I already touched on this a bit now because you mentioned that you did proof of concept and you worked a lot with them before you signed the contract. How important was it for you to purchase Intercom, this ability from the vendor to demonstrate applicability to your specific use cases and general business context, like to your channels, use cases, client inquiries. On a scale of 1-5, the ability from the vendor to demonstrate this applicability, how important was it?

Expert 00:21:19

They have been able to work with us. They've been quite open on the testing. I think they were also happy to have a bigger scale customer testing with them. They have led, I would say, with ROI in mind. That was what was important to us. **The AI is just the tool to bring down cost of support**. That's what made it clear. They worked with us on looking of the metrics I've shared with you, like how many percentage of tickets that AI is taking, the cost per ticket reduction, and then the overall satisfaction of AI. From a costing perspective, it was to be sure that we model something that doesn't blow out with scale.

Client 00:21:58

Okay. You're touching a bit on different buying factors that I want to explore further. Right now, I'm only interested in understanding specifically the importance on the vendor ability to demonstrate that the tool would actually work in your specific context pre-sale. We're going to discuss other buying factors that I call the clarity on the value realization.

In other words, helping you develop a business case and get confidence that you will achieve the value that was promised. Also, we're going to discuss the importance of transparent and predictable pricing. Those are separate. Right now, I'm only interested in understanding the importance of essentially of proving the concept pre-sales on a scale of 1-5.

Expert 00:22:47

Got you. Really important. Really, the product guy speaking, everything around AI can be extremely. Nothing will be approved without the solid POC. These contracts are reviewed by people from tech, from security, from legal. For sure, everything going in tech, everything with the AI, will ask for very strong POC. They've been supportive. In April, that's what we've been doing with them. We do have a good relationship with Intercom. As I told you, we have a stronghold partnership with them.

Client 00:23:24

All right. On a scale of 1-5, how important would you say it is?

Expert 00:23:29

Five for this POC for the vendor test and realization of value. I would say they've done a four.

Client 00:23:38

I'm interested in their performance delivering this proof of concept pre-sales, not the delivery of value once implemented. I'm more interested in understanding your perception.

Expert 00:23:49

That's a four then.

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Client 00:23:51

Okay. I'm interested in understanding this more in detail. I would want to understand specifically a few things, like the process that was followed by Intercom, also the team that was involved by Intercom, and how did this proof of concept look like. They hooked up to your knowledge base and they worked with your team to understand the most common customer inquiries, they tested a thousand of them? I want to understand this in detail. Can you walk me through this proof of concept?

Expert 00:24:22

I was not in the deeds but I can tell you what we evaluated from the test instance. We have the test instance plugged to our production knowledge base. They ingested all the content, then CS team validated the more orchestration piece of their workflow, how they handle from an AI agent to a human agent.

For me, from a product perspective, as I said, we have quite complex tool, how I can really run the edge case, and how he's able to link to the proper knowledge base article, regurgitate the proper knowledge base information in the right context, playing a bit with a bit of the semantic, different words for same meanings. That's why, in April, it was a bit too much and we said, "No, these answers are very too partially correct." That was that. Really looking at the quality of the answer was my main involvement. From the CS team, they also looked at the configuration and the automation for them, but **that was pretty good** already.

Client 00:25:23

You weren't very involved here, so perhaps you don't have the answer here, but do you recall from the Intercom team, what roles were supporting this proof of concept? Did you have, for example, an AE plus an AI specialist plus an engineer? Do you recall those details?

Expert 00:25:42

I cannot say. I was not in direct contact with other people than their CSM.

Client 00:25:47

All right. You rated Intercom a four. Can you tell me why it's not a five? What would you have needed?

Expert 00:25:57

I think it would have been good to work even more in partnership with them, understanding a bit of where **they were falling short in the answer**. The transparency was not there from their side. Maybe, as you say, we didn't get access to some engineering power from their end, which would have been interesting and maybe we'd have adopted then a bit earlier. Instead of November, it would have come somewhere in August, I don't know. That's why only four.

Client 00:26:23

All right. Moving on to the next one. Now, I want to move to the clarity on the value realization. One thing is the proof of concept that it works, but the other thing that I'm interested is also pre-sales, like having very good clarity and confidence that the value that is promised by the vendor will be there, either the ROI or the automation rates or whatever was the value. How important was that on a scale of 1-5 to have high clarity on value realization pre-sales?

Expert 00:26:56

Pre-sales, you would mean without a POC?

Client 00:27:00

The POC was on pre-sales, so it can be with the POC. The last buying factor was more about having confidence that the tool would actually work. Here, I'm talking more about having confidence that the tool will actually deliver value, which I think it's related, it has to work to deliver value. **I want to take more into account the costs and the benefits and all of that** related to the tool delivering value

Expert 00:27:27

Basically, I'm puzzled with the pre-sales world. I think it's really coming from the POC. We're looking at two things that are multiplying each other, which is the automation and the ability for Fin AI to act as an agent. The multiplication factor is we want to keep our CSAT at 98%. This is the quality. We want to make sure the experience for the customer is good and they're not just reacting violently to a robot that just rehash the same information. That was very important to us. Happy to invest in AI. If for $1 put in AI, we get $2 out, it's totally fine.

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Client 00:28:06

Did you work with Intercom on a business case or on an ROI model before you signed the contract?

Expert 00:28:13

As I told you, we work together. They knew our number, and this is what you can aim to get. They're really good at that. I think even before Fin AI, **they were already good at selling their product in this way**. They have breakdown in the automation, the speed, the resource time. That's where they are really good at doing and keeping very simple metrics, not going too far, too complicated. From their side, that was where we were pitching them. High automation is not necessarily a high value. We were really looking at the value with them and keeping the CSAT score high.

Client 00:28:53

On a scale of 1-5, how would you rate this?

Expert 00:28:56

That was very important, five. On the score, I would say four because, still, the CX Score is not where I want it to be. I told you it's around 80%. Would love to be more at 90%. They need to help us or we need to help them improving that for the customer.

Client 00:29:17

Got it. I'm more interested in the satisfaction that you have with the pre-sales performance of the vendor, not now that you understand the CX Score, but more like the satisfaction on working with Intercom pre-sales to get this confidence that you will get this value.

Expert 00:29:35

If I talk to sales, I'm generally not happy. I'm trying to give you the best answer I can give you without being too harsh.

Client 00:29:43

All right. You will keep it at a four?

Expert 00:29:46

Yeah.

Client 00:29:47

All right. Moving on to pricing. I'm splitting it in two. The first one is transparent and predictable pricing, and the second one is lower price than other options. How important was it for you that the vendor for AI agents, for Fin in this case, offered a pricing model that was both transparent and predictable, on a scale of 1-5?

Expert 00:30:10

From a scale from 1-5, I would say, the pricing is relatively clear at the high level. There is other company **that are just much more unclear**, opaque, shady even. It's based on usage, it's based on interaction and resolution. That's easy for us to be clear on that. The scale with usage, it's okay for us. I think we see growth, but it's not explosive growth. That's something we can plan ahead. I would love to see a bit more projection, a bit more predictability from them. I would say from an importance, it's a four. Same from the results from Intercom, I would say 3.5 if I can put the 0.5.

Client 00:30:53

Thank you. The second one on pricing, how important was it that the vendor offers lower price or lower cost of ownership than alternatives? In here now, I'm not talking about the value. I'm talking specifically on how much you would pay for Fin versus other alternatives or making sure that you have a vendor that has a relatively low price and low cost. How important was that?

Expert 00:31:21

I would say not so much. For the importance, if I have to give it a number, it was two. We were not looking to make a cheap buy. We were looking to save money on the overall workflow. Not really important. We want to see faster ROI than saving on the contract, so I would say two. Where Intercom is doing, I would say 3.5 as well. Would love to see the price going down a little bit more now that it's more settled, cost of the model is cheaper. I don't see the feature set really, really increasing as well.

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Client 00:31:55
Thank you. The next buying factors that I want to test are more on the implementation approach, so how the vendor worked with you to implement the solution after you signed the contract. How important was it for you that you would have a vendor with a strong consultative approach, meaning that they would not only give you the technology, that they would actually work with you and have the necessary expertise to make sure that you use the technology correctly?

Expert 00:32:22
Also quite important. I feel like I rate everything at five. Realistically, for Fin AI in Intercom, I would rate it as a three because we are already integrated with Intercom. We knew already well how it works. We wanted to enable Fin AI. We are a B2B SaaS company also building AI for our customers. We know how hard it is to make it right from the beginning.

We were not really caring too much on the consultative approach at the beginning, so that will be a three. How they did deliver, I would say more four. They have been quite supportive in our different phase of the POC, looking for feedback, understanding, telling us which metric to look at, what to improve on the automation. They've been quite supportive, but they're also quite eager to learn at the same time, so four.

Client 00:33:14
Tell me a little bit more about that. How did Intercom work with you post-sales? Did they assign a specific team? Did they set up a cadence? Did they have an implementation journey that they laid out with you so that you could follow together?

Expert 00:33:31
They laid up a plan, what to look out. I would say relatively standard, nothing surprising. Some few regular touch points to see how we were doing. They were checking our setup also from their end, sending the right documentation, where we were doing wrong. I think it really helped us to launch that quickly. When things are running, they also are not pestering us too much as well. That's good. That's what I like with them.

Client 00:33:59
Okay. Just more like the couple of months after you signed the contract for implementation, how often did you interact with them? Was it weekly?

Expert 00:34:10
It was weekly, so really quite high cadence there. We say, "No, in the POC, **we're not happy**," then they were following at least once a month, maybe with a bit of holiday in the middle. They pushed back in September, where we bring back the topic and we redo a POC. During the second POC, I think it lasted only two weeks. That was pretty quick because everything was already set up, just needed to be reactivated. That was also quickly.

Client 00:34:37
All right. What roles from Intercom interacted with you for implementation? Do you recall? Was it delivery specialists, engineers?

Expert 00:34:46
We didn't have engineers. I don't think so. I would need to review that, but we had our usual client partner and then a delivery someone, more focusing on the feature on the AI, that knew really well how to set it up, but it was not an engineer.

Client 00:35:01
It seems from what you're saying that they were proactive. You say that they were sending documentation, pointing out things.

Expert 00:35:09
They ar. They always have been quite proactive, at least for the partner we have.

Client 00:35:16
All right. The next one is the support process with integration, integrating with other systems that you have to make sure that it can address customer inquiries that need these integrations. For example, with your billing system to address anything on payments, refunds, etc. or any

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key systems or workflows within your company. From what you told me earlier, it seems like you didn't focus too much on these iterations. It was more based on your knowledge base. Still, I want to test again this. Is the specific time factor was very important in your decision to have a vendor that could help you with the technical capabilities to develop these integrations, on a scale of 1-5?

Expert 00:35:59

The integration we have, they have it out of the box. Salesforce is where we have all the customer data. I was telling you this is important for the context. We have Jira for then everything that is more than just a chat. The knowledge base is on Document360. All that are integration that they had by default. It needed a bit of a click and set up. Maybe Document360 was a bit more complicated. I think we have a bit of issue. That was more from the Document360 site than Intercom. That is the extent of everything. Of course, the whole data is ingested in our data warehouse, and we do have some few custom made script displayed with the API to do some final setup on their end.

Client 00:36:48

All right. The buying factor talks more about deep support with integrations. In this case, it seems like this wasn't needed because it was mostly out of the box and perhaps a bit of setup in some cases, but it was not like you needed some integrations.

Expert 00:37:04

I think **we have also a strong team of engineers**. It's like we're 900, we have 250 engineers. We're not just too scared if we need to develop a bit of code, here and there. To do what we want, we can do it.

Client 00:37:20

All right. How important was this then, taking all this in mind?

Expert 00:37:26

Four and four.

Client 00:37:28

Next one is the availability of self-serve tools for adoption and implementation. In other words, once you signed the contract and you needed to set everything up, you didn't necessarily rely on personal guidance from their delivery team, that you could have access to everything from documentation, tutorials, demos, and user friendly tools that could help you set everything up by yourself. How important was that from 1-5?

Expert 00:37:54

From 1-5, I would say four, again, so not the most important but relatively high. I would score them a five. I'm just trying to be faster in my answer. They're doing well in that. That's why we like Intercom. It's a bit also on the ease of use related to that. It's quite easy to navigate the app, find documentation. **They have a good knowledge base, and even, like I was telling you, we get access to the API, the documentation is good**, we can develop some integration ourselves.

Client 00:38:28

Got it. Can I tell you more about this? You already mentioned that the documentation that has their knowledge base, easy to access that. Those are good examples. Any other self-serve tools that you found good? For example, self-serve tools to do the testing.

Expert 00:38:46

They have a set off of demo learning material that is also pretty good to set up. They have also free access. You can set up your Intercom. You can boot up a personal Intercom pretty easily just to test to see how things work. That's a good way to check few things.

Client 00:39:04

What do you mean by personal Intercom?

Expert 00:39:07

You can boot up your own instance of Intercom pretty quickly for free, for one week or two.

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Client 00:39:13

All right. This covers the buying factors that we wanted to go over with you. Thank you very much for your time.

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